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How a Hawiye tribe used to live

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Document Type: Essay

Original Page: 88

Culture (OWC): [Somali \(M004\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1919-1922

Coverage Date: 1919-1922

Place Coverage

Hawiye; Somalia, Djibouti, and southeastern Ethiopia

Section Title(S): V. The 'Vaunt' Of The Tribes

V. The 'Vaunt' of the Tribes

The 'vaunt' of the tribes had a very great part in the life of the Hawiyya Somali peoples. I render here with 'vaunt' /Ital. '[vanto](#)'/ the Somali denomination [f\[unknown\]an](#), which also corresponds etymologically to the Arabic [fa\[unknown\]hr](#), having the same technical meaning. Thus, the 'vaunt' is the exaltation of the virtues, merit, and glories of one's own tribe and the joking or ironical or even offensive satire of the other tribes. It is done in various ways: in verses more generally, or by means of short stories; sometimes in the stylized form of the [sadde\[unknown\]hliya](#) (the 'by three of which we have spoken above (¹); at other times proverbs preserve this 'vaunt' in the memory. Thus, even poetic contrasts in alternate strophes that answer each other in favor of the two competing tribes are not rare.

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. Cf. above p. 19.

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